PEW RESEARCH CENTER
August 23-26, 2012 OMNIBUS
FINAL TOPLINE
N=1,010

ASK ALL:

PEW.1 Please think about each of the following candidates. **[INSERT NAME, RANDOMIZE]** In the past few days, have you come to have a MORE favorable opinion of him, a LESS favorable opinion, or hasn't your opinion of him changed lately?

	More favorable	Less favorable	Opinion has not changed	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. Barack Obama				
August 23-26, 2012	16	22	56	5
TREND FOR COMPARISON[1]				
Jan 29-Feb 1, 2010	18	22	57	3
January 22-25, 2010	8	33	55	4
December 4-7, 2009	12	27	57	3
September 11-14, 2009	19	26	53	1
June 25-28, 2009	13	20	63	4
May 21-24, 2009	18	21	60	1
April 9-13, 2009	20	18	60	2
March 20-23, 2009	22	19	56	3
February 27-March 2, 2009	23	20	56	1
February 6-9, 2009	23	16	60	1
2008 Election Trend				
October 31-Nov 3, 2008	25	25	49	1
October 24-27, 2008	24	21	52	3
October 17-20, 2008	33	23	43	1
October 10-13, 2008	29	21	48	2
October 3-6, 2008	28	23	47	2
September 26-29, 2008	31	23	45	1
September 19-22, 2008	25	20	53	2
September 12-15, 2008	20	20	58	2
September 5-8, 2008	20	20	59	1
August 29-31, 2008	29	19	50	2
August 22-25, 2008	22	21	54	3
August 15-18, 2008	16	21	60	3
August 8-11, 2008	15	18	64	3
August 1-4, 2008	16	22	60	2
July 25-28, 2008	17	21	59	3
July 18-21, 2008	16	22	60	2
July 11-14, 2008	15	17	64	4
July 3-7, 2008	17	17	62	4
June 27-30, 2008	21	19	56	4
June 20-23, 2008	16	16	66	2
June 13-16, 2008	17	15	64	4
June 6-9, 2008	19	17	61	3
May 30-June 2, 2008	17	21	58	4
May 22-25, 2008	18	20	60	2
May 16-19, 2008	19	19	59	3
May 9-12, 2008	20	23	55	2
May 2-5, 2008	11	25	59	5
April 25-28, 2008	16	24	58	2
April 18-21, 2008	18	24	54	4
March 28-31, 2008	18	27	52	3
March 20-24, 2008	22	30	46	2

[1] From February 2009 through February 2010, question asked about the "past few weeks" and did not introduce Obama as a "candidate."

PEW.1 CONTINUED …

	More favorable	Less favorable	Opinion has not changed	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
b. Mitt Romney				
August 23-26, 2012	18	26	46	11

ASK ALL

Next,

PEWWP.1 What ONE WORD best describes your impression of **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]**? Just the one word that best describes him. **[IF "DON'T KNOW" PROBE ONCE WITH:** it can be anything, just the ONE word that comes to mind …**]** How about, **[INSERT NEXT ITEM]** **[OPEN-END. ENTER FULL RESPONSE EVEN IF MORE THAN ONE WORD.]**

NOTE: The numbers listed represent the number of respondents who offered each response; the numbers are not percentages.

a. Mitt Romney

Aug 23-26 2012		Mar 15-18 2012		Dec 8-11 2011		Oct 13-16 2011	
32	Honest	31	No/No way/Nope	47	Mormon	60	Mormon
31	Business/Businessman	30	Rich	23	No/No way	17	Health care/program
31	Rich	19	Good/Good man	19	Flip-flop/Flip flopper	13	Flip-flop/Flip-flopper
23	Good	18	Mormon	15	Good/Good man	13	Good/Good man
21	Conservative	15	Moderate	15	OK	12	No/No way
18	Republican	11	Business/Businessman	10	Religion/Religious	12	Possibility/Possible
15	Leader/Leadership	11	Flip-flop/Flip-flopper	9	Business/Businessman	11	Religion/Religious
14	OK	11	Idiot	9	Honest	10	Intelligent/Intelligence
13	Liar	11	Possibility/Possible	9	Not sure/Unsure	10	Moderate
12	Arrogant	10	Distrust/Untrustworthy	9	Possibility/Possible	10	Old
13	President/Presidential	9	Arrogant	8	Loser	9	Boring
10	Crook/Crooked	9	Candidate	8	Slick	9	OK
10	Out of touch	9	Conservative	7	Conservative	9	Politician
9	Capable	9	Not sure/Unsure	7	Crook/Crooked	8	Competent
9	Distrust/Untrustworthy	9	OK	7	Idiot	8	President/Presidential
9	Don't like/Dislike	8	Crook/Crooked	7	Like	7	Conservative
9	Fake	8	Fake	7	Wishy-washy	7	Honest
8	Better	8	Like/Likeable	6	Distrust/Untrustworthy	7	Not sure/Unsure
8	Mormon	8	President/Presidential	6	Rich	7	Questionable/Questions
8	Sincere	8	Out of touch	5	Boring	7	Business/Businessman
7	Great/Greatest	8	Wealth/Wealthy	5	Liar	6	Established/Establishment
7	Greedy	7	Electable	5	Moderate	6	Fair
7	Wealthy	7	Liar	4	Alright	6	Fake
6	Dishonest	6	Don't like/Dislike	4	Bland	5	Experience
6	Fair	6	Fair	4	Candidate	5	Liar
6	Idiot	6	Interesting	4	Confident	5	Liberal
6	Intelligent	6	Qualified	4	Dumb	5	Like
6	Jerk	6	Leader	4	Fair	5	Money
6	Success/Successful	6	Winner	4	Intelligent/Intelligence	5	Qualified
5	Experienced	6	Yes	4	Interesting	5	Rich
5	Favorable	5	Liberal	4	Maybe	5	Strong
5	Loser	5	Money	4	Politician	4	Best
5	Not middle class/Doesn't care about middle class	5	Questionable/Questions	4	President/Presidential	4	Capable
5	Phony	4	Bad	4	Questionable/Questions	4	Confident
5	Smart	4	Competent	4	Smart	4	Crook/Crooked
5	Unknown	4	Frontrunner	4	Steady	4	Dull
4	Bad	4	Honest	4	Stupid	4	Front runner
4	Change/Changeable	4	Jerk	3	Bad	4	Jobs
4	Confident	4	Maybe	3	Competent	4	Loser
4	Competent	4	Politician	3	Dull		Not interested/
		4	Phony	3	Electable	4	Uninterested

PEWWP.1 CONTINUED…

a. Mitt Romney

4	Flip-flopper	4	Scary	3	Experienced	4	Republican
4	Hypocrite	4	Michigan	3	Fake	3	Alright
4	Hope/Hopeful	3	Ass***/Ass	3	Jerk	3	Ass
4	Integrity	3	Don't care	3	Liberal	3	Bad
4	Money/Money hungry	3	Boring		Not interested/	3	Candidate
4	Politician/Political	3	Average	3	Uninterested	3	Decent
4	Prejudice/Prejudiced	3	Change/Changeable	3	Republican	3	Distrust/Untrustworthy
4	Questionable	3	Charismatic	3	Undecided	3	Electable
4	Responsibly	3	Clueless			3	Hypocrite
4	Scary	3	Intelligent/Intelligence			3	Jerk
4	Selfish	3	Loser			3	Leader
4	Solid	3	Massachusetts			3	Massachusetts
4	Unfavorable	3	Stupid			3	Nice
4	Unqualified	3	Republican			3	Smooth
4	Wrong	3	Undecided			3	Stable
3	Adequate	3	Weak			3	Undecided
3	Alright	3	Wonderful				
3	Ambitious	3	Hope/Hopeful				
3	Best	3	Second/Second choice				
3	Clueless						
3	Confused/Confusing						
3	Elite/Elitist						
3	Excellent						
3	Family man						
3	Honorable						
3	Horrible						
3	Millionaire						
3	Old						
3	Professional						
3	Puppet						
3	Shady						
3	Sneaky						
3	Stiff						
3	Stupid						
3	Trustworthy						
3	Undecided						
3	Likeable						
3	Nice						
		2	No answer/Nothing	24	No answer/Nothing	10	No answer
312	Other	361	Other	299	Other	296	Other
159	Don't know	222	Don't know/Refused	351	Don't know	313	Don't know
N=1,010		N=1,009		N=1,008		N=1,007	

b. Paul Ryan

Aug 23-26 2012	
26	Conservative
25	Intelligent
23	Good
22	Unknown
22	Young
15	Energetic
15	Honest
13	OK
13	Smart

PEWWP.1 CONTINUED…

b. Paul Ryan

10	Idiot
8	Extreme/Extremist
8	Great
7	Phony
7	Scary
6	Confident
6	Fair
6	Favorable
6	Follower
5	Arrogant
5	Competent
5	Dynamic
5	Excellent
5	Integrity
5	Leader/Leadership
5	Nice
5	Rich
5	Stupid
4	Ass/Ass****
4	Clueless
4	Dangerous
4	Dedicated
4	Disingenuous
4	Joke
4	Knowledgeable
4	Liar
4	Likeable/Like him
4	Loser
4	Sharp
4	Too conservative/Ultra conservative
4	Undecided
4	Unknowing/ Unknowledgeable
4	Unfavorable/Do not favor him
3	Articulate
3	Awesome
3	Candidate
3	Capable
3	Crazy
3	Dislike/Unlikeable
3	Educated
3	Fake
3	Jerk
3	New/Newcomer
3	Opportunist
3	Poor
3	Serious
3	Sneaky
3	Unsure
3	Wrong
5	No answer/Nothing
291	Other
321	Don’t know/Refused

N=1,010

NOTE: The numbers listed represent the <u>number of respondents</u> who offered each response; the numbers <u>are not</u> percentages.

NO QUESTION PEW.2

ASK ALL:

PEW.3 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE;] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy					
August 23-26, 2012	38	30	15	16	1
August 16-19, 2012	33	32	16	19	*
August 9-12, 2012	30	31	20	18	1
August 2-5, 2012	33	29	20	17	1
July 26-29, 2012	32	30	20	19	*
July 19-22, 2012	39	29	16	16	*
July 12-15, 2012	32	33	18	17	1
July 5-8, 2012	34	28	18	19	1
June 28-July 1, 2012	38	28	15	18	1
June 21-24, 2012	33	32	17	17	*
June 14-17, 2012	39	28	15	17	*
June 7-10, 2012	35	32	15	18	*
May 31-June 3, 2012	37	34	13	14	1
May 24-27, 2012	33	31	19	16	1
May 17-20, 2012	35	30	16	19	*
May 10-13, 2012	40	26	16	17	*
May 3-6, 2012	38	29	13	20	*
April 26-29, 2012	34	32	17	16	1
April 19-22, 2012	35	35	13	14	2
April 12-15, 2012	39	28	16	17	1
April 5-8, 2012	37	31	16	16	1
March 29-April 1, 2012	34	33	15	18	1
March 22-25, 2012	36	29	16	18	1
March 15-18, 2012	40	35	11	14	1
March 8-11, 2012	37	32	14	17	*
March 1-4, 2012	41	27	15	17	1
February 23-26, 2012	37	33	14	15	1
February 16-20, 2012	33	32	16	17	1
February 9-12, 2012	42	30	14	13	1
February 2-5, 2012	38	32	16	13	1
January 26-29, 2012	35	31	16	19	*
January 19-22, 2012	35	30	16	19	1
January 12-15, 2012	33	32	14	20	1
January 5-8, 2012	39	31	15	15	*
December 15-18, 2011	36	32	14	16	1
December 8-11, 2011	41	29	13	16	1
December 1-4, 2011	40	33	13	13	1
November 17-20, 2011	35	33	16	15	1
November 10-13, 2011	39	31	15	14	*
November 3-6, 2011	37	31	15	17	1
October 27-30, 2011	38	33	14	15	1
October 20-23, 2011	38	32	14	16	1
October 13-16, 2011	39	32	14	14	*
October 6-9, 2011	43	28	14	14	1
September 29-October 2, 2011	46	26	14	14	*
September 22-25, 2011	44	33	11	11	*
September 8-11, 2011	40	30	15	14	1
September 1-4, 2011	44	30	11	15	*
August 25-28, 2011	44	28	14	13	1
August 18-21, 2011	44	29	12	14	1

PEW.3 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
August 4-7, 2011	46	30	11	13	1
July 28-31, 2011	43	30	13	13	*
July 21-24, 2011	41	32	13	13	1
July 14-17, 2011	41	30	14	14	1
July 7-10, 2011	36	30	15	18	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	38	32	13	16	1
June 23-26, 2011	37	29	15	19	*
June 16-19, 2011	39	33	14	13	*
June 9-12, 2011	39	30	15	16	1
June 2-5, 2011	35	34	17	14	*
May 19-22, 2011	33	34	17	16	*
May 12-15, 2011	32	32	17	18	2
May 5-8, 2011	40	35	15	9	1
April 21-25, 2011	41	33	12	14	*
April 14-17, 2011	44	30	14	12	1
April 7-10, 2011	46	30	14	10	*
March 31-April 3, 2011	42	31	16	11	0
March 24-27, 2011	36	32	17	15	*
March 17-20, 2011	38	32	17	13	*
March 10-13, 2011	40	30	16	13	*
March 3-6, 2011	37	31	17	13	1
February 24-27, 2011	49	29	11	10	*
February 17-20, 2011	35	33	14	17	*
February 10-13, 2011	36	34	13	16	*
February 3-6, 2011	35	37	14	14	*
January 20-23, 2011	37	33	14	15	1
January 13-16, 2011	37	29	15	18	1
January 6-9, 2011	39	37	11	12	1

SEE TRENDS FOR PREVIOUS YEARS: http://www.people-press.org/files/2011/11/NII-Economy-Trends.pdf

b. Controversial comments about rape and abortion made by Missouri representative Todd Akin					
August 23-26, 2012	25	21	21	33	1
c. News about candidates for the 2012 presidential election					
August 23-26, 2012	27	31	19	22	1
August 16-19, 2012	32	27	19	22	1
August 9-12, 2012	27	27	21	24	1
August 2-5, 2012	31	25	19	23	1
July 26-29, 2012	25	28	21	25	1
July 19-22, 2012	35	22	17	25	1
July 12-15, 2012	33	24	20	23	*
July 5-8, 2012	29	26	20	25	*
June 28-July 1, 2012	32	24	19	25	*
June 21-24, 2012	27	30	17	25	1
June 14-17, 2012	31	30	15	24	*
June 7-10, 2012	30	29	16	25	1
May 31-June 3, 2012	29	28	19	23	1
May 24-27, 2012	32	28	16	24	1
May 17-20, 2012	31	26	19	23	*
May 10-13, 2012	34	23	18	24	*
May 3-6, 2012	29	27	19	24	*
April 26-29, 2012	29	29	18	23	1
April 19-22, 2012	29	29	20	20	1
April 12-15, 2012	32	28	16	23	1
April 5-8, 2012	31	27	18	23	*
March 29-April 1, 2012	23	29	21	27	*

PEW.3 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
March 22-25, 2012	28	28	18	25	1
March 15-18, 2012	28	31	17	24	*
March 8-11, 2012	28	27	21	23	*
March 1-4, 2012	31	24	20	24	1
February 23-26, 2012	28	29	18	24	1
February 16-20, 2012	25	29	19	25	2
February 9-12, 2012	35	25	18	20	1
February 2-5, 2012	30	27	20	21	1
January 26-29, 2012	28	30	21	21	1
January 19-22, 2012	28	30	17	24	*
January 12-15, 2012	29	29	18	23	1
January 5-8, 2012	29	30	16	25	*
December 15-18, 2011	26	24	20	29	1
December 8-11, 2011	27	27	18	28	*
December 1-4, 2011	25	28	20	26	1
November 17-20, 2011	24	31	21	23	1
November 3-6, 2011	22	31	20	26	1
October 27-30, 2011	21	26	21	30	1
October 20-23, 2011	21	28	22	28	1
October 13-16, 2011	26	29	22	23	1
October 6-9, 2011	25	25	23	27	1
September 29-October 2, 2011	27	26	21	25	*
September 22-25, 2011	25	26	23	25	1
September 15-18, 2011	24	28	21	27	1
September 8-11, 2011	22	26	21	31	*
September 1-4, 2011	22	23	22	32	1
August 25-28, 2011	22	22	22	33	1
August 18-21, 2011	27	26	19	28	1
August 11-14, 2011	19	24	20	36	1
August 4-7, 2011	18	21	22	37	1
July 28-31, 2011	17	27	21	35	1
July 21-24, 2011	17	22	28	32	*
July 14-17, 2011	18	26	27	28	1
July 7-10, 2011	16	23	27	33	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	21	28	24	25	2
June 23-26, 2011	19	26	24	31	*
June 16-19, 2011	23	29	23	25	*
June 9-12, 2011	18	30	22	30	1
June 2-5, 2011	21	31	22	26	*
May 26-29, 2011	20	27	24	28	*
May 19-22, 2011	15	27	24	32	1
May 12-15, 2011	15	22	26	35	1
May 5-8, 2011	16	24	27	32	1
April 21-25, 2011	18	26	23	32	1
April 14-17, 2011	20	23	29	27	1
March 24-27, 2011	13	19	26	41	1
March 10-13, 2011	15	21	26	38	0
February 10-13, 2011	16	19	24	40	*
February 3-6, 2011	15	20	23	42	*

SEE TRENDS FOR PREVIOUS YEARS: http://www.people-press.org/files/2011/11/NII-Election-Trends.pdf

NO QUESTION PEW.4

ASK ALL:
As you may know, both the Democratic and Republican parties will be holding their conventions over the next few weeks…
RANDOMIZE PEW.5 AND PEW.6
ASK ALL:
PEW.5 Are you interested in following what happens at the upcoming DEMOCRATIC National Convention in Charlotte, or aren't you that interested in the convention? **[IF YES, ASK:** Is that very or fairly interested?**]**

Aug 23-26 2012		Aug 2008	Jul 2004	Jul 1992
43	Interested	59	36	53
23	Very interested	31	19	26
19	Fairly interested/Don't know	28	17	27
57	Not interested	41	63	45
1	Don't know/Refused **(VOL).**	*	1	2

RANDOMIZE PEW.5 AND PEW.6
ASK ALL:
PEW.6 Are you interested in following what happens at the upcoming REPUBLICAN National Convention in Tampa, or aren't you that interested in the convention? **[IF YES, ASK:** Is that very or fairly interested?**]**

Aug 23-26 2012		Aug 2008	Aug 2004	Jul 2000	Jul 1996
44	Interested	48	46	34	44
25	Very interested	22	27	14	21
19	Fairly interested/Don't know	26	19	20	23
55	Not interested	51	53	64	55
1	Don't know/Refused **(VOL).**	1	1	2	1

IF ASKED PEW.5 FIRST ASK PEW.7 BEFORE PEW.8. IF ASKED PEW.6 FIRST ASK PEW.8 BEFORE PEW.7
ASK ALL:
PEW.7 As I read some things that will happen at the Democratic Convention, tell me how interested you are in each event. First, are you very interested, fairly interested, not too interested or not at all interested in **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]**?

		Very interested	Fairly interested	Not too interested	Not at all interested	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a.	Watching Barack Obama's acceptance speech					
	Aug 23-26, 2012	29	22	12	37	1
	August, 2008	33	25	14	27	1
	July, 2004 ***(Kerry)***	25	26	14	34	1
	July, 1992 ***(Clinton)***	25	32	20	22	1
b.	Watching the roll call of the states as they cast their ballots					
	Aug 23-26, 2012	19	23	17	40	1
	August, 2008	23	22	18	37	*
	July, 2004	22	24	19	34	1
	July, 1992	22	29	25	23	1
c.	Learning about the Democratic Party's platform					
	Aug 23-26, 2012	27	28	15	30	*
	August, 2008	28	36	13	23	*
	July, 2004	31	31	15	22	1
	July, 1992	38	34	16	11	1
d.	Watching Bill Clinton's speech at the convention					
	Aug 23-26, 2012	26	26	13	34	*

IF ASKED PEW.5 FIRST ASK PEW.7 BEFORE PEW.8. IF ASKED PEW.6 FIRST ASK PEW.8 BEFORE PEW.7
ASK ALL:

PEW.8 As I read some things that will happen at the REPUBLICAN Convention, tell me how interested you are in each event. First, are you very interested, fairly interested, not too interested or not at all interested in **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]**?

		Very Interested	Fairly Interested	Not too Interested	Not at all Interested	Don't know
a.	Watching Mitt Romney's acceptance speech					
	Aug 23-26, 2012	23	21	16	40	1
	August, 2008 ***(McCain)***	24	28	15	33	*
	July, 2000 ***(Bush)***	23	30	12	34	1
b.	Watching the roll call of the states as they cast their ballots					
	Aug 23-26, 2012	19	24	16	40	1
	August, 2008	17	22	20	41	*
	July, 2000	17	23	15	44	1
c.	Learning about the Republican Party's platform					
	Aug 23-26, 2012	27	25	16	31	1
	August, 2008	23	35	16	26	*
	July, 2000	23	35	14	27	1
d.	Watching Paul Ryan's speech at the convention					
	Aug 23-26, 2012	23	23	14	39	2